

has been discovered in the cuneiform documents⁹ as the name of the eldest son of Nabonidus, the last king of Babylon." Among the various allusions to this prince in the cuneiform literature, the most important are those in the two inscriptions of Ur, and in the annals of Nabonidus, the chief document relating to the fall of Babylon. As the reference in the small inscription¹¹ of Ur is the most complete and consequently the most important, I append a translation and transcription. In this document Nabonidus speaks as follows:

<i>Balātu ša ūme ruḡūti</i>	<i>Life for long days</i>
<i>ana širiḡti šurḡām</i>	<i>give as a gift to me</i>
<i>u ša Belšaruḡur</i>	<i>and cause to dwell</i>
<i>māru rēštū</i>	<i>in the heart of Belshazzar</i>
<i>ḡit libbiya</i>	<i>my first born son,</i>
<i>puluḡti ilūtika rabīti</i>	<i>the offspring of my body,</i>
<i>libbuš šuškinma</i>	<i>reverence for thy great God-</i>
<i>ā iršā</i>	<i>head. May he ne'er incline</i>
<i>xiḡēti</i>	<i>to sin,</i>
<i>lale balātu lišbi.</i>	<i>may he be filled with the</i>
	<i>fulness of life.</i>

In the second column of the great inscription of Ur," the king, after describing the restoration of the temple of *Ebarra*

⁹ Sir Henry Rawlinson in the *Athenæum*, March, 1854, p. 341, 'A letter from Bagdad.' See also Oppert, ZDMG, viii. 598.

¹⁰ The name occurs in the inscriptions as that of probably two other persons: (a) In 'Keilinschriftliche Bibliothek,' ii. 60, l. 59, where the ruler of the city of the *Kišeši*, one of the tribes conquered by Sargon, is called *Belšaruḡur*. (b) The *Belšaruḡur* son of *Balātu* mentioned by Pinches in the *New York Independent*, 1889, Aug. 15, is probably not, as he thinks, the son of Nabonidus but of some ordinary person, possibly of some one named after the king's son (?). For the proper name *Balātu*, see Peiser 'Babylonische Verträge,' No. ix. l. 2. (*Ztschr. für Assyriologie*, vii. 66, l. 2.)

¹¹ Text, IR. 68, col. ii. 22-23, and Winckler's 'Keilschrifttexte,' p. 48. Translation, *Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society*, xix. (1861), 195 ff.; repeated also, 'Records of the Past,' v. 143 ff., Talbot: Oppert, 'Expedition en Mesopotamie,' i. 262.

¹² 'Keilinschriftliche Bibl.' iii. pt. 2, p. 82. *Belšaruḡur māru rēštū . . . ḡit (?) libbiya šuriku ūmešu, ā iršā xiḡēti*, 'Belshazzar my first born . . . the offspring of my body, make long his days, may he not incline to sin.' Peiser transcribes in the 'Keilinschriftliche Bibliothek' . . . *lu (?) ux bi a = ḡit (?) libbiya*.

and offering a devout petition to Šamas, the sun-god, that the sacred shrines may now remain uninjured, closes with a prayer for his own well being and with a supplication for *Belšaruṣur* his first-born in almost the same words as the above. Why this especial mention of the king's son occurs in these inscriptions of Ur is doubtful. It may be conjectured with Tiele ('Geschichte,' 463) that *Belšaruṣur* was governor of this province in Southern Babylonia and had Ur as his capital, or it is possible that Nabonidus attached some special religious importance to the cult of the moon-god local in this place. The petition here that the king's son might not incline to sin may perhaps indicate that the prince had in some way offended the prejudices of the religious classes, who, as is well known, supervised the preparation of the inscriptions. From the allusion to the prince in the annals¹³ of Nabonidus it appears that the son of the king was a number of years with the lords and army in Akkad, most probably in the capacity of commander in chief, while his father was residing in Tema free from the cares of government. It is worthy of notice here that in the annals the name *Belšaruṣur* does not occur, the allusion being merely to the 'son of the king'; but there can be little doubt that the reference is to the first-born.

In addition to these three passages from the historical literature, there are numbers of references to *Belšaruṣur* in the contract tablets, none of which, however, throw any further important historical light on his character.*

As *Belšaruṣur* is the only king's son mentioned with such prominence in the Babylonian inscriptions,¹⁴ and as it is espe-

¹³ Annals, col. ii. 5, during the seventh year of Nabonidus, col. 2. 10, during the 10th year. See also col. ii. 19 and 23.

¹⁴ Compare, however, Nbpl. col. ii. 69, 'Keilinschriftl. Bibl.' iii. pt. 2, 4, mention of Nebuchadnezzar; and col. iii. 6 ff. of *Nabūšulīšir*, his brother. In later documents mention is made of Cambyses, son of Cyrus, as co-regent and king of Babylon during his father's lifetime. (See Tiele 'Geschichte,' 483, 484.) In the inscription of Antiochus Soter, VR. 66, 25, ('Keilinschr. Bibl.' iii. pt. 2, 138, 25), mention is made of Seleucus, his son and vice-king. Delattre, 'Solomon, Asurbanipal et Baltasar,' 1883, p. 5, compares in connection with *Belšaruṣur* the cases of Solomon and Sardanapalus, both of whom exercised the vice-regal dignity during the life of their respective fathers.

* See additional note C.

cially stated that the lords of the kingdom and army were with him (probably under his supervision) in Akkad, it seems highly probable that he was a very important personage in the government, a theory which is strengthened by the fact that his father, Nabonidus,* was more of an archæologist than a ruler, and far more interested in the discovery of a forgotten site than in the affairs of his kingdom. *Belšaruçur*, therefore, as some critics have argued,¹⁵ may have really been co-regent; but, as will be seen subsequently, the author of the Book of Daniel could not, as they thought, have had this idea in mind in calling him king of Babylon.

Comparing the *Belšaruçur* of the inscriptions with Belshazzar of the Book of Daniel, the following important differences are apparent. The former was the son of the last king of Babylon, but never reigned except possibly as co-regent, while the latter is distinctly called the last king and the son of Nebuchadnezzar. There can be little doubt that both of these statements were made by the author of Daniel in perfect good faith. A number of commentators¹⁶ have sought to prove that the Belshazzar of the Book of Daniel was not necessarily meant by the author as the last king of Babylon, but was intended for Evilmerodach, son of Nebuchadnezzar; a view advanced in support of the statement in verse 2, that Belshazzar was the son of Nebuchadnezzar. Following this theory, some considered Belshazzar merely a secondary name. (So Zündel 'Daniel,' 26; Niebuhr 'Geschichte,' 30, etc.) It is difficult to understand, however,

¹⁵ Floigl, 'Cyrus und Herodot,' 24; Andreä, 'Beweis des Glaubens,' 1888, p. 249; Smith in the 'Dictionary of the Bible'; Meinhold, 'Dissertation,' 30, n. 2, etc.

¹⁶ So Marsham, 'Canon chron.,' 596 ff.; Conring, 'Advers. Chron.' c. 13; Harenberg, 'Dan.' ii. pp. 454 ff.; Hofmann, 'Die siebenzig Jahre des Jeremia und die siebenzig Jahrwochen des Daniel,' p. 44; Hävernicks, 'Neue kritische Untersuchungen,' pp. 72 ff.; M. v. Niebuhr, 'Geschichte Assurs und Babels,' p. 42.; Wolff in the 'Studien und Kritiken,' 1858, p. 684 note a.; Zündel, 'Daniel,' 33; Unger, 'Kyaxares und Astyages,' pp. 28, 29. Keil, 'Dan.' 145, although knowing of the discovery of the name in the inscriptions thought that the *Belšaruçur*, son of Nabonidus, of the inscriptions must have been named after Belshazzar-Evilmerodach son of Nebuchadnezzar! Quatremere in his 'Annales de la philosophie chrétienne,' 1838, (Migne, 'Dic. de la Bible,' ii. p. 30, note, 1845), advanced the theory in support of Jeremiah xxvii. 7, that Nabonidus, as an usurper, associated with himself Belshazzar,

how the author could make Daniel declare to the Babylonian monarch that *his* kingdom was about to pass to the Medes and Persians, unless the prophecy were intended for the last king. There would be little point in such a warning, if it were given a generation before its actual fulfillment. We may compare in this connection the indifference of Hezekiah to the prophecy of Isaiah of the ultimate deportation to Babylon and degradation there of all the Jewish royal family. In Isaiah xxxix. 8, Hezekiah said: "Good is the word of the Lord, which thou hast spoken . . . for there shall be peace and truth in *my* days." In addition to this it is evident that if the author of Daniel did not really regard his Belshazzar as the last king of Babylon, but as Evilmerodach, he must have omitted without mention a period of twenty years between the death of the latter and the foreign supremacy; *i. e.* that between the two contiguous and closely related statements of the death of Belshazzar and the accession of Darius the Median, the reigns of several kings were passed over in silence. That an author should do this knowingly without a word of explanation, as some writers have sought to show, seems a preposterous supposition." It appears perfectly clear that the Biblical author regarded Belshazzar as the last king of Babylon before the coming of the Medes and Persians.

son of Evilmerodach and grandson of Nebuchadnezzar, in order to strengthen his position. The view that Belshazzar and Nabonidus were identical was held by Josephus (*Antt.*, x. 11, 2); where he states that 'Baltasar' was called 'Naboandelus' by the Babylonians. (Cf. also 'Contra Apionem,' i. c. 20). This idea was followed by J. D. Michaelis 'Daniel,' 46; Bertholdt, 'Daniel,' 344; Bleek, Kirms, Hengstenberg, Hävernicks, 'Daniel,' p. 172; Ewald 'Gesch.', v. 85, note; Herzfeld, 'Gesch.', i. 154; Browne, 'Ordo Saeculorum,' 178.

Sulpitius Severus, 'Hist.', ii. 6, considered Belshazzar a younger brother of Evilmerodach, both being sons of Nebuchadnezzar.

Scaliger (see 'Isagogicorum chronologiae canonum libri tres,' iii. p. 190.) and Calvisius, who were followed by Ebrard, 'Comm. zur Offenbarung Johannis,' 45, and Delitzsch 'Real Encycl.', iii. 472, identified him with Laborosoarchod (*Labašimarduk*), son of Neriglissar.

¹¹ Cf. Zündel and Kranichfeld 'Dan.', 25, 28, who believed that Belshazzar was Evilmerodach, and explained this silence regarding the intervening period and the connection of two statements so far apart, by supposing that they were brought together because the latter was the sequence of the former!